

Let's Make Accessible
Creativity Support
Tools (CSTs)!

Expanding Norms, Negotiating Bodies

*How Artists with
Disabilities Perceive
and Use Creative
Tools*

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Alli Shahrouti (fine art photographer with cerebral palsy), describes not using any "adapted" photography tools, but works with a human assistant—directing tripod, light meter, camera setup, when to trigger the shutter, and how to edit photos.

Community

Learn more about the work and artists who shaped it.
Artists' sites are linked inside.



PDF DOI

*This zine was made
by Miriam Brody
miriam-brody.com*

"Other people...I think community and other people are my greatest tools" — Alex Friedman (neurodivergent sculpture artist)

This challenges the individualist framing of the "independent" artist — and by extension, the idea that all accessible tools should aim to make users independent.

Taken together...

- Community
- Meeting Basic Needs
- The Body

...artists are expanding the norms of what makes an accessible creative practice possible.

When we center these dimensions, designing for creative access becomes a space for imagination, not limitation.

Meeting Basic Needs

Theater director, film maker, and writer Regan Linton, who uses a wheelchair, described co-designing a shower chair with students. She said, *"It seems ancillary to art, but if I can't shower or use the bathroom, I can't create the art."*

Basic access needs and care are foundational to creative work.

The Body as a Creative Constraint

"I feel like my own life and experience was expanded by acquiring a disability and having to think outside of the box"
—Regan Linton

Creativity is embodied. Artists listen to their body, letting it guide their pace, perspective, and material choices.